

A vacation at sea

Cruise ships offer passengers a luxury vacation as they travel. The biggest cruiser today holds nearly 9,000 people. It is the length of 4 football fields, and has 23 swimming pools and 24 elevators.



Containers are stacked in racks on the deck.



The front of the ship is marked with a sighting mast. Otherwise it would be hidden from the crew in the bridge by the cargo on the deck.



A loading line

On the side of a ship is a row of lines called a Plimsoll mark. A certain one of these lines must always be above water or the ship may sink. There are several lines, as ships float at different levels in salt or fresh water, in summer or winter, and in the tropics or the North Atlantic.

Plimsoll mark



Save our souls

In an emergency at sea, passengers and crew put on life jackets and send an SOS signal. Rescue is carried out by a lifeboat crew.

Ship shapes

The seaways of the world are busy with ships of all shapes and sizes.



Naval frigate



Roll-on/roll-off ferry



Oil tanker